Ritika Ahuja, Chief Operating Officer of Big Boy Toyz; Founder, Queens Drive Club

has watched at close quarters.

Ahuja, 47, is Chief Operating Officer at luxury pre-owned car retailer Big Boy Toyz and the founder of Queens Drive Club, a community for women who drive high-performance cars. Her fascination began with her father, who also loved automobiles. She drove a Hyundai Accent in college, later graduated to a Mercedes E-Class and, in 2013, moved to her first sports car—a Bentley GT Convertible.

The Bentley had been an aspiration since 2009, when Ahuja was working in Dubai and saw two women driving a pink Bentley convertible with the music turned up. "I think it just became like my aspiration for life," she recalls.

She currently drives a BMW XM and enjoys the Audi RS Q8 and Ferrari Portofino; but the Bentley remains a favourite. For Queens Drive Club events, she has driven everything from a Ferrari Portofino to a McLaren 720S.

Ahuja says what has changed the most in the supercar culture is who makes the decision. Five or six years ago, men overwhelmingly walked into luxury-car showrooms alone. Today, she estimates that nearly half the customers arrive as couples or families. More importantly, women increasingly make purchase decisions themselves.

The typical woman driving such cars, according to Ahuja, is between 25 and 50, and is often a professional or entrepreneur. Electric performance cars such as the Porsche Taycan and MG Cyberster have been drawing growing interest over the past year, she says.

